

Dodékathlos: A Phygital Board Game

Rulebook & Game Instructions

INTRODUCTION & OVERVIEW

Dodékathlos is a hybrid, cooperative board game for **1 to 5 players** aged **11 and up**. It blends physical components, such as a game board, dice, and cards, with a companion smartphone app that drives the epic narrative.

Players must work together to help Heracles complete his legendary trials. The game features two modes: a **Short Mode** (6 Labors) and a **Full Mode** (12 Labors).

OBJECTIVE

Your goal is to successfully conquer the Labors of Heracles.

- In **Short Mode**, you must claim at least **4 out of 6 Labors** to win.
- In **Full Mode**, you must claim at least **8 out of 12 Labors** to win.

THE HEROES & STATS

Players choose from 5 mythological characters. If playing in **Solitary Mode (1 Player)**, you must play as Heracles. As the player count increases, you can add the remaining companions to your team.

Each character possesses unique ratings (from 1 to 5) across **5 Core Attributes: STRENGTH, DEXTERITY, INTELLIGENCE, WISDOM, CHARISMA**. These points are added to your dice rolls to beat a Labor's Difficulty Class.

Hero	Strength	Dexterity	Intelligence	Wisdom	Charisma
Heracles	5	3	1	2	4
Iolaus	3	5	2	3	2
Athena	2	3	5	4	1
Theseus	4	2	2	2	5
Hermes	1	4	4	1	5

GAME COMPONENTS (BOX KIT)

- **1 GAME BOARD:** Featuring a historical map of ancient Greece showcasing the geographic locations of the 12 Labors. The top of the board features a "Checklist Track" to monitor your conquests.

- **5 HERO CARDS:** Double-sided cards showing the character's artwork and stats on the front, and their mythological biography on the back.
- **5 CHARACTER PAWNS:** Placed on the board over the specific Labor currently being attempted.
- **2 SIX-SIDED DICE (2d6):** Standard dice rolled during challenges. On one of the dice, the number 1 is replaced by a **Lightning Bolt** symbol.
- **PERIL & AID DECK:** Whenever a player rolls a Lightning Bolt, they must draw a card from this deck. It contains four card types:
 1. **Zeus's Aid:** Adds bonus points to your current roll.
 2. **Time Bonus:** Grants extra Hourglasses.
 3. **Hera's Interference:** Adds extra points to the Labor's target difficulty.
 4. **Time Deduction:** Discards Hourglasses from your pool.
- **VICTORY & DEFEAT TOKENS:** Double-sided coin tokens (Gold for Victory, Black for Defeat) to track completed Labors on the board.
- **COMPANION APP:** Downloadable smartphone application featuring **Nike** as the main voice narrator.

TIME & THE HOURGLASS MECHANIC

Time is managed inside the app via **Hourglasses**.

- **Starting Pool:** 12 Hourglasses in Short Mode / 26 Hourglasses in Full Mode.
- **The Cost of a Labor:** Simply entering and attempting a Labor automatically costs 1 Hourglass.
- **Retries:** If you fail a roll, you can pay 1 Hourglass to retry immediately. You can attempt a Labor a maximum of 3 times (totaling 3 Hourglasses spent) before being forced to retreat.

THE GAMEPLAY LOOP

1. The Setup & Intro

Download the app, select your Game Mode, and input the number of players. **Nike** will introduce the myth.

2. Resolving a Labor

For each Labor, the App states the target **CD (Difficulty Class)** and the 3 **Attributes** required.

The designated player pays 1 Hourglass and rolls the dice.

VICTORY SCENARIO

Tap "Victory" in the app. Nike explains how the hero won, displaying an image of the actual metope from the **Archaeological Museum of Olympia**. Place a **Gold Coin** on the board and move to the next Labor.

DEFEAT SCENARIO

If you fail 3 times (having paid 2 extra Hourglasses), the Labor is lost. Tap "Defeat", place a **Black Coin**, and move forward (provided you can still meet the minimum win condition).

TIE SCENARIO

You may immediately reroll the dice for free without spending an additional Hourglass.

DIFFICULTY CLASSES (CD) & LABORS

Required Attributes Per Labor

- **Nemean Lion:** Strength + Dexterity + Charisma
- **Lernean Hydra:** Intelligence + Dexterity + Strength
- **Ceryneian Hind:** Dexterity + Wisdom + Charisma (*Full Mode Only*)
- **Erymanthian Boar:** Strength + Dexterity + Wisdom (*Full Mode Only*)
- **Augean Stables:** Intelligence + Wisdom + Strength
- **Stymphalian Birds:** Dexterity + Intelligence + Charisma (*Full Mode Only*)
- **Cretan Bull:** Strength + Dexterity + Charisma
- **Mares of Diomedes:** Strength + Wisdom + Charisma (*Full Mode Only*)
- **Belt of Hippolyta:** Charisma + Intelligence + Dexterity
- **Cattle of Geryon:** Strength + Wisdom + Dexterity (*Full Mode Only*)
- **Apples of the Hesperides:** Intelligence + Wisdom + Charisma (*Full Mode Only*)
- **Cerberus:** Strength + Wisdom + Charisma

Short Mode (6 Labors)

- **1 Player (Solo):** Lion: CD 15 - Hydra: CD 16 - Stables: 16 - Bull: CD 17 - Belt: CD 18 - Cerberus: 19
- **2 Players:** Lion: CD 15 (P1) - Hydra: CD 15 (P2) - Stables: CD 16 (P1) - Bull: CD 16 (P2) - Belt: CD 28 (Cooperative) - Cerberus: CD 30 (Cooperative)
- **3 Players:** Lion: CD 15 (P1) - Hydra: CD 15 (P2) - Stables: CD 16 (P3) - Bull: CD 38 (Trio) - Belt: CD 40 (Trio) - Cerberus: CD 42 (Trio)
- **4 Players:** Lion: CD 26 (Pair A) - Hydra: CD 26 (Pair B) - Stables: CD 28 (Pair C) - Bull: CD 28 (Pair D) - Belt: CD 52 (All 4) - Cerberus: CD 55 (All 4)
- **5 Players:** Lion: CD 26 (Heracles+Athena) - Hydra: CD 26 (Hermes+Iolaus) - Stables: CD 28 (Theseus+Heracles) - Bull: CD 28 (Athena+Hermes) - Belt: CD 30 (Iolaus+Theseus) - Cerberus: CD 65 (All 5)

Full Mode (12 Labors)

- **1 Player:** Labors 1–4: CD 15 - Labors 5–8: CD 17 - Labors 9–11: CD 19 - Labor 12: CD 21
- **2 Players:** Labors 1–6 (Alternating Solo): CD 16 - Labors 7–12 (in pair): CD 28

- **3 Players:** Labors 1–6 (Alternating Solo): CD 16 - Labors 7–12 (Co-op Trio): CD 40
- **4 Players:** Labors 1–6 (Alternating Pairs): CD 27 - Labors 7–12 (Co-op All 4): CD 52
- **5 Players:** Labors 1–5 (Solo Turn: Heracles, Iolaus, Athena, Theseus, Hermes): CD 16 - Labor 6 (Heracles+Athena): CD 28 - Labor 7 (Hermes+Iolaus): CD 28 - Labor 8 (Theseus+Heracles): CD 29 - Labor 9 (Athena+Hermes): CD 29 - Labor 10 (Iolaus+Theseus): CD 30 - Labors 11–12 (All 5 Together): CD 65

MUSEUM INTEGRATION & NEW GAME+ PERKS

At the end of the game, victory or defeat, Nike delivers a special announcement: **the adventure continues in the real world!**

If players visit the **Archaeological Museum of Olympia**, they will find special QR codes. Scanning these codes permanently unlocks **Special Perks** on their physical character cards to be used in all future playthroughs at home:

HERACLES: Lion's Hide

Once per game, Heracles can completely ignore one drawn Hera's Interference Card.

IOLAUS: The Faithful Charioteer

In any Solo or Pair challenge featuring Iolaus, the target CD of the Labor is permanently reduced by 2 points.

ATHENA: Owl's Gaze

While Athena is in play, before a player rolls, she can look at the top card of the Peril/Aid deck. If it is a Hera card, she can place it at the bottom of the deck.

THESEUS: Peace Treaty

Once per game, if a roll fails by 3 points or fewer, Theseus can use his Charisma to immediately convert the failure into a victory, saving precious time.

HERMES: Winged Sandals

Once per game, Hermes can use his divine speed to instantly restore 2 Hourglasses to the app's time pool.